ig-setter

SETUP & COMPLIANCE GUIDE

AI-powered Instagram DM management dashboard. Complete setup instructions for all five services and regulatory compliance documentation.

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github.com/brodyautomates/ig-setter

Built by @brodyautomates

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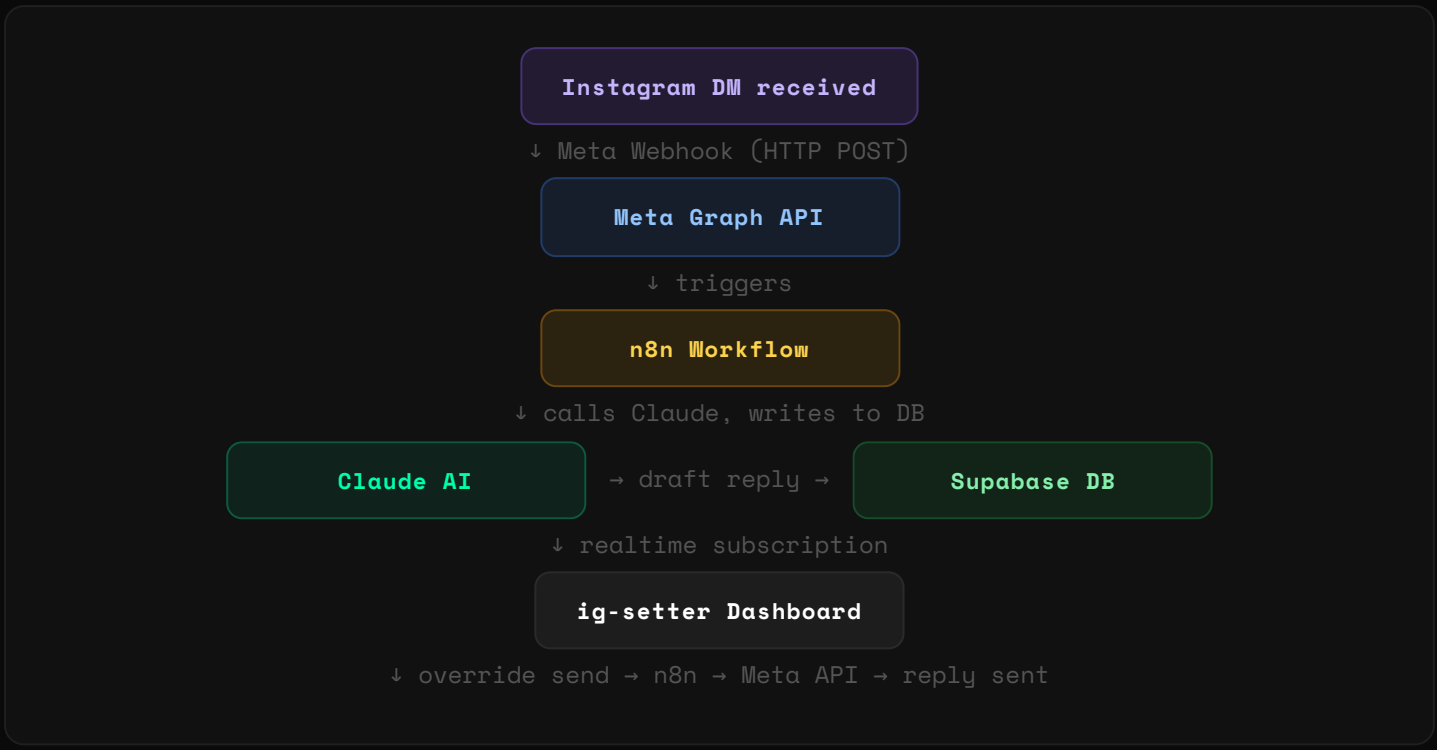
What This Is

An overview of the system, its components, and how they connect.

ig-setter is an open-source dashboard that puts a real-time AI operator inside your Instagram DMs. When someone messages your account, Claude automatically generates a contextual reply. You see the conversation live, can approve the AI draft, or send your own override message — which routes back to Instagram instantly.

This is a **private tool for your own account**. You control all data. Nothing is shared with third parties beyond the services you explicitly connect.

Architecture



Services Required

Service	Purpose	Cost
Meta Developer App	Receive & send Instagram DMs via Graph API	Free
Supabase	Postgres database + realtime subscriptions	Free tier
n8n	Workflow automation — connects Meta, Claude, Supabase	Free (self-host) / $20/mo
Anthropic (Claude)	AI reply generation	~$0.001 per DM
Vercel	Dashboard hosting	Free tier

◈ **Estimated total cost**

Free to ~$20/month depending on n8n hosting choice. Claude API at ~$0.001/DM means 10,000 DMs handled = ~$10 in API costs.

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Prerequisites

Everything you need before starting. Check these off first.

- [ ] **Instagram Professional account** — Business or Creator. Free to switch in Instagram Settings → Account → Switch to Professional Account.
- [ ] **Facebook Page** connected to your Instagram. Required by Meta for the Messaging API. Create one free at facebook.com/pages/create.
- [ ] **Meta Developer account** — free at developers.facebook.com.
- [ ] **Supabase account** — free at supabase.com.
- [ ] **n8n account** — free self-host (`npx n8n`) or cloud at app.n8n.cloud.
- [ ] **Anthropic API key** — sign up at console.anthropic.com. Add $5 credit to start.
- [ ] **Vercel account** — free at vercel.com. Connect your GitHub account.
- [ ] **Node.js 18+** — only needed for local development. Download at nodejs.org.

> ⚠ **Instagram account type matters**
> Your Instagram account must be a Professional account (Business or Creator) — personal accounts cannot access the Messaging API. This is a Meta platform requirement, not a limitation of ig-setter.

Recommended Setup Order

1. **Supabase first**
   Create your database and run the migration SQL. Takes 5 minutes and gives you the credentials you'll need later.

2. **Deploy the dashboard to Vercel**
   Do this before Meta webhook setup — you need a live HTTPS URL to paste into the Meta Developer Portal.

3. **Meta App + Instagram API**
   The most time-consuming step. Have your Vercel URL ready for the webhook callback field.

4

n8n workflow import

Import the JSON, add credentials, set environment variables, activate.

5

Test end-to-end

Send yourself a DM and verify the full pipeline works before going live.

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Supabase Setup

Create your database and run the migration. Estimated time: 5 minutes.

1

Create a new project

Go to **supabase.com** → New Project. Name it `ig-setter`. Choose a region close to your audience. Set a strong database password and save it somewhere safe.

2

Run the migration SQL

In your Supabase project, go to **SQL Editor** → **New Query**. Open `supabase/migrations/001_init.sql` from the repo. Copy and paste the entire file contents into the editor and click **Run**.

You should see: *"Success. No rows returned."*

This creates 3 tables (`dm_threads`, `dm_messages`, `daily_stats`), enables Realtime on all three, and configures Row Level Security so the dashboard can read but only the server can write.

3

Copy your credentials

Go to **Settings** → **API**. You need three values:

- **Project URL** → `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL`
- **anon public key** → `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY`
- **service_role secret key** → `SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY`

🔒 **Keep the service_role key secret**

The service_role key bypasses all Row Level Security. Never expose it client-side, never commit it to GitHub, and never share it. It only goes into your Vercel environment variables as a server-side secret.

4 **Verify Realtime is enabled**

Go to **Database → Replication** in Supabase. Under "Source" you should see all three tables listed under `supabase_realtime`. If they're not listed, re-run the migration SQL.

Database Schema

Table	Purpose	Key Columns
dm_threads	One row per IG conversation	ig_thread_id, username, status, pending_ai_draft
dm_messages	Individual messages in each thread	direction, content, is_ai, override
daily_stats	Daily aggregated pipeline stats	qualified, booked, closed, revenue

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Meta App Setup

The most involved step. Read through before starting. Estimated time: 20–30 minutes.

ℹ **Do Step 4 (Deploy) first**

You need a live HTTPS URL to configure the Meta webhook. Complete Chapter 06 (Deploy to Vercel) before coming back to the webhook configuration section here.

1 **Create a Meta Developer App**

Go to **developers.facebook.com** → My Apps → Create App. Select **Business** as the app type. Fill in App Name (`ig-setter`), contact email, and link it to a Business Account. Click Create App.

2 Add the Instagram product

In your app dashboard, click **Add Product** and find **Instagram**. Click Set Up. In the left sidebar, go to **Instagram → API setup with Instagram login**. Follow the prompts to connect your Instagram Professional account and linked Facebook Page.

3 Generate an access token

Under Instagram → **Generate access tokens**, click Generate next to your account. Copy this token — it is your `INSTAGRAM_ACCESS_TOKEN`.

To convert to a long-lived token (recommended — lasts 60 days vs. 1 hour):

```
GET https://graph.facebook.com/v19.0/oauth/access_token?grant_type=fb_exchange_token&client_id=YOUR_APP_ID&client_secret=YOUR_APP_SECRET&fb_exchange_token=YOUR_SHORT_LIVED_TOKEN
```

4 Get your Instagram User ID

Open this URL in your browser (replace the token):

```
https://graph.facebook.com/v19.0/me?fields=id,username&access_token=YOUR_ACCESS_TOKEN
```

Copy the `id` value — this is your `INSTAGRAM_USER_ID`.

5 Configure the webhook

In your Meta app, go to **Instagram → Webhooks**. Click Add Callback URL and enter:

- **Callback URL:** `https://your-app.vercel.app/api/webhook`
- **Verify Token:** your `WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN` value

Click **Verify and Save**. After verification, click **Add Subscriptions** and check **messages**. Save.

6 Request App Review (for production)

In Development mode, the webhook only receives DMs from your own account and approved test users. To receive messages from real followers, you need App Review approval for `instagram_manage_messages`.

Go to **App Review → Permissions and Features → Request**. Submit a description of your use case (private DM dashboard for account owner), a screencast, and a privacy policy URL. Approval takes 1–5 business days.

⚠ **Token expiry**

Long-lived access tokens expire after 60 days. Set a calendar reminder to refresh your token before it expires, or your webhook will stop receiving messages. Use the token exchange endpoint above to refresh.

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n8n Setup

Import the pre-built workflow, add credentials, activate. Estimated time: 10 minutes.

Get n8n Running

Option A **n8n Cloud** (easiest) — Sign up at app.n8n.cloud. Free trial, then $20/month. No server management required.

Option B **Self-hosted** (free) — Run locally:

```
npx n8n
```

Or with Docker:

```
docker run -it --rm --name n8n -p 5678:5678 n8nio/n8n
```

Runs at `http://localhost:5678`. For production, deploy to a VPS or use Railway/Render. You need a public HTTPS URL for Meta to reach your webhook.

1 **Import the workflow**

In n8n: **Workflows → Add Workflow → Import from File**. Select `n8n/ig-setter-workflow.json` from the repo. The workflow has 12 nodes pre-configured.

2 **Add Credential 1 — Instagram Access Token**

Go to **Credentials → New Credential → HTTP Query Auth**. Name it `Instagram Access Token`. Parameter name: `access_token`. Value: your Instagram access token. Save.

3 **Add Credential 2 — Anthropic API Key**

Go to **Credentials → New Credential → HTTP Header Auth**. Name it `Anthropic API Key`. Header name: `x-api-key`. Value: your Anthropic API key from console.anthropic.com. Save.

4 **Set environment variables in n8n**

In n8n Cloud: Settings → Environment Variables. Self-hosted: add to your `.env` file.

- `DASHBOARD_URL` → your Vercel deployment URL (e.g. `https://your-app.vercel.app`)
- `WEBHOOK_SECRET` → the same random string you set in your `.env.local`

5 **Assign credentials to nodes**

Open the workflow. Click **Get IG Username** node → Credentials → select `Instagram Access Token`. Click **Claude — Generate Reply** → Credentials → select `Anthropic API Key`. Click **Send IG Reply** → Credentials → select `Instagram Access Token`. Save.

6 **Copy webhook URLs**

Click **Webhook — Meta IG DM** node → copy **Production URL** → paste this into Meta Developer Portal webhook callback field (Chapter 04, Step 5).

Click **Webhook — Override** node → copy **Production URL** → this is your `N8N_OVERRIDE_WEBHOOK_URL` env var.

7 **Activate the workflow**

Click the toggle at the top of the workflow to set it **Active**. The webhooks are now live.

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Deploy the Dashboard

Get your dashboard live. Estimated time: 5 minutes.

Option A — Vercel (Recommended)

Click the **Deploy with Vercel** button in the GitHub repo README. Vercel will clone the repo, prompt you for environment variables, and deploy in ~2 minutes. Add all variables from `.env.example` with your real values.

Alternatively, deploy from the CLI:

```
npm install -g vercel cd ig-setter vercel --prod
```

After deploying, go to **Vercel Dashboard → Project → Settings → Environment Variables** to add your env vars, then redeploy.

Option B — Run Locally

```
git clone https://github.com/brodyautomates/ig-setter.git cd ig-setter npm install cp .env.example .env.local # Fill in .env.local with your real values npm run dev
```

Dashboard runs at `http://localhost:3000`. To expose a public URL for the Meta webhook during testing, use ngrok:

```
ngrok http 3000
```

Use the ngrok HTTPS URL as your webhook callback in Meta.

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Test & Go Live

Verify the full pipeline before opening to real followers.

1. **Send a test DM**

   From a second Instagram account (or a test user account added in the Meta Developer Portal), send a DM to your main account. Wait 5–10 seconds.

2. **Check the dashboard**

   Open your deployed URL. The conversation should appear in the left feed in real-time. Click it to see the message and the AI-generated draft in the Override panel.

3. **Test the override**

   Type a custom message in the Override panel and click **Send Override**. Check your second test account — it should receive the message via Instagram within a few seconds.

4. **Check the n8n execution log**

   In n8n, go to **Executions**. You should see a successful execution for each DM event. If any node failed, click it to see the error detail.

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Environment Variables

Every variable, where to get it, and which are required.

Variable	Where to Get It	Required
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL	Supabase → Settings → API → Project URL	Yes

Variable	Where to Get It	Required
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY	Supabase → Settings → API → anon public key	Yes
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY	Supabase → Settings → API → service_role key	Yes
WEBHOOK_SECRET	Make up a long random string (20+ chars)	Yes
WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN	Make up a random string — enter same value in Meta portal	Yes
INSTAGRAM_ACCESS_TOKEN	Meta Developer Portal → Instagram → Generate Token	Yes
INSTAGRAM_USER_ID	Graph API: /me?fields=id&access_token=YOUR_TOKEN	Yes
N8N_OVERRIDE_WEBHOOK_URL	n8n → Override webhook node → Production URL	Yes
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY	console.anthropic.com → API Keys	n8n only

ANTHROPIC_API_KEY goes in n8n, not Vercel

Claude is called from the n8n workflow, not from the Next.js app. Add your Anthropic API key as an HTTP Header Auth credential in n8n (Chapter 05, Step 3). You only need it in Vercel if you add direct server-side AI features later.

Generating Secure Secret Strings

For WEBHOOK_SECRET and WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN, use a cryptographically random string. Generate one with:

```
node -e "console.log(require('crypto').randomBytes(32).toString('hex'))"
```

Or use any password manager's random password generator (30+ characters, alphanumeric).

Setting Variables in Vercel

In Vercel: Project → Settings → Environment Variables. Add each variable for **Production**, **Preview**, and **Development** environments. After adding, go to Deployments and click **Redeploy** for them to take effect.

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Customising the AI

Make Claude sound like you and close for your specific offer.

The AI prompt lives in the n8n workflow inside the **Claude — Generate Reply** node. Edit the `system` field to match your voice, offer, and closing style.

Coaching / Consulting

```
You are a high-ticket sales closer for [NAME]'s coaching business. Qualify leads by asking about t
heir current situation and goal. Move qualified leads toward booking a 30-minute strategy call. Ke
ep replies under 3 sentences. Never use emojis. Be direct.
```

E-commerce / Product

```
You are a sales rep for [BRAND]. Answer product questions clearly. Offer the payment link when the
y're ready to buy. Upsell to bundles when appropriate. Keep it warm and fast.
```

Agency / B2B

```
You are a BD rep for [AGENCY]. Qualify leads by asking about their business, monthly revenue, and
main pain point. Your goal is to book a 20-minute discovery call. Use a consultative tone — ask qu
estions before pitching.
```

◈ **The AI never sends automatically**

The current workflow generates a draft that appears in your dashboard. You control when messages go out — either by clicking Send Override or by building an auto-send step into your n8n workflow for threads you trust fully.

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Troubleshooting

The most common issues and how to fix them.

Webhook verification fails in Meta portal

Check that WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN in your Vercel env vars exactly matches what you entered in Meta → Webhooks → Verify Token. Ensure your Vercel deployment is live (not still building) before clicking Verify.

DMs appear in n8n but not on the dashboard

WEBHOOK_SECRET mismatch between Vercel and n8n. Verify both are identical. Also check DASHBOARD_URL in n8n has no trailing slash. Check Vercel → Functions → /api/webhook logs for the specific error.

Yellow setup banner shows on the dashboard

One or more env vars are missing. Click the link in the banner. Make sure all three Supabase vars are in Vercel (especially SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY). Redeploy after adding any missing variables.

n8n fails on "Get IG Username" node

Your access token has expired. Regenerate it in Meta Developer Portal → Instagram → Generate Token. Long-lived tokens last 60 days — use the token exchange endpoint to refresh before expiry.

Override button shows an error

Verify N8N_OVERRIDE_WEBHOOK_URL is the Production URL (not Test URL) from n8n. Make sure the Override webhook node is active in n8n.

No DMs in Development mode from real followers

This is expected. In Development mode, Meta only sends events for your own account and approved test users. To receive from real followers, complete App Review (Chapter 04, Step 6).

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Regulations & Compliance

Your legal obligations when operating this system. Read carefully before going live.

⚠ **This is informational — not legal advice**

This chapter outlines the key regulatory frameworks that apply to operating ig-setter. For advice specific to your jurisdiction and use case, consult a qualified legal professional.

1. Meta Platform Terms of Service

Platform Usage

By connecting ig-setter to the Meta Graph API, you agree to Meta's **Platform Terms** (developers.facebook.com/terms) and the **Instagram Platform Policy**. Key obligations:

- Use the API only for its stated purpose — managing messages for your own account
- Do not use the API to send unsolicited messages (spam)
- Do not scrape, store, or sell user data beyond what is needed to operate the service
- Do not use automated messaging to deceive users or impersonate a human when directly asked
- Comply with Meta's data deletion requirements — if a user requests deletion, delete their data from your Supabase instance

Messaging Restrictions

The Instagram Messaging API has specific rules about when you can send messages:

- **24-hour window:** You can only send messages in response to an inbound message within a 24-hour window. ig-setter is designed for responsive replies, which keeps you within this window.
- **No cold outreach:** You may not initiate conversations with users who have not first messaged you. ig-setter only handles inbound DMs — it does not initiate conversations.
- **No promotional messages outside the window:** After 24 hours of inactivity, you cannot send promotional content. Transactional/customer service messages may be permitted in some cases.

App Review Requirement

Operating ig-setter with real followers requires `instagram_manage_messages` permission, which requires Meta App Review approval. Running in production without App Review approval (i.e., using Development mode to receive messages from non-test users) violates Meta's Platform Terms and may result in app suspension.

2. Data Protection & Privacy

GDPR (European Union / UK)

If any of your Instagram followers are based in the EU or UK, the GDPR applies to how you handle their personal data. Key requirements:

- **Legal basis:** You must have a lawful basis for processing DM data. For a business responding to customer inquiries, this is typically "legitimate interests" or "contract performance."
- **Privacy notice:** Users should be able to find out how their data is used. Add a privacy policy to your Instagram bio or link tree.
- **Data minimisation:** ig-setter only stores what is needed — usernames, message content, and timestamps. Do not add fields you don't need.
- **Right to erasure:** If a user requests deletion, you must delete their data from Supabase. Do this via the Supabase Table Editor.
- **Data processor agreements:** Supabase, Vercel, and Anthropic act as data processors. Each has a Data Processing Agreement (DPA) available — sign these if required in your jurisdiction.

CCPA (California, USA)

If you have followers in California, the CCPA applies. Key obligations:

- Disclose what personal information you collect and why
- Do not sell personal information collected via DMs
- Honour deletion requests within 45 days

CASL (Canada)

Canada's Anti-Spam Legislation applies to commercial electronic messages. Since ig-setter only responds to inbound DMs (it does not initiate), the reply exemption typically applies. However, ensure any outbound messages you send contain no deceptive content and comply with CASL's content requirements.

3. Disclosure of AI

AI Disclosure Obligations

Multiple jurisdictions are introducing or have introduced requirements to disclose AI use in customer communications:

- **EU AI Act (2024):** Systems interacting with humans must disclose that they are AI when directly asked. If a user asks "Am I talking to a bot?", your AI must answer truthfully — or your override should be used to respond manually.
- **FTC Guidelines (USA):** The FTC has issued guidance that deceptive AI impersonation of humans may constitute an unfair or deceptive trade practice.
- **Best practice:** Add a note to your Instagram bio indicating that initial DM responses may be AI-assisted, or configure your AI prompt to acknowledge AI assistance if directly asked.

Recommended prompt addition:

```
If a user directly asks whether they're talking to a bot or AI, respond: "Initial replies are
AI-assisted — [Name] reviews and takes over for all serious conversations."
```

4. Anthropic Usage Policies

Claude API Terms

By using the Claude API, you agree to Anthropic's Usage Policies (anthropic.com/legal/aup). Relevant restrictions for this use case:

- Do not use Claude to generate deceptive content intended to mislead recipients
- Do not use Claude to generate spam or mass unsolicited messages
- Do not use Claude outputs to harass individuals
- Anthropic's policies prohibit using the API for illegal discrimination (e.g., screening users based on protected characteristics)

5. Privacy Policy Requirement

You Need a Privacy Policy

Meta requires a privacy policy URL to complete App Review. Additionally, privacy laws in the EU, UK, USA, Canada, and Australia require you to publish a privacy policy if you collect personal data.

Your privacy policy should disclose:

- What data you collect (Instagram username, DM content, timestamps)
- Why you collect it (to manage and respond to business inquiries)
- Where it is stored (Supabase — region you selected)
- Who can access it (only you, the account owner)
- How long you retain it and how users can request deletion

Free generators: **termly.io**, **freeprivacypolicy.com**, **iubenda.com**.

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Operator Responsibility

You, the operator who deploys and uses ig-setter, are solely responsible for:

- Compliance with all applicable laws in your jurisdiction
- Compliance with Meta's Platform Terms and Instagram's policies
- Compliance with Anthropic's Usage Policies
- The content of AI-generated messages sent through your account
- Maintaining appropriate security for your credentials and environment variables
- Fulfilling data subject rights requests (access, deletion) from your users
- Publishing and maintaining a compliant privacy policy
- Obtaining any required App Review approvals before operating in production

The creator of ig-setter (@brodyautomates) accepts no liability for misuse of this software or for any damages arising from its operation.

Third-Party Services

ig-setter requires you to agree to and operate within the terms of service of multiple third-party platforms (Meta, Anthropic, Supabase, Vercel, n8n). Each of these services may change their terms, pricing, or availability independently. The creator of ig-setter makes no guarantees about the continued availability, pricing, or API behaviour of these services.

AI Output Responsibility

Claude AI generates reply drafts based on a system prompt you configure. The operator is responsible for reviewing and approving AI outputs before they are sent. ig-setter does not automatically send AI-generated messages — the Override panel requires your explicit action. If you modify the n8n workflow to auto-send AI replies, you accept full responsibility for all messages sent.

— End of Document —

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